ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** a good shower of rain	His ripe corn needed rain; he kept looking at the sky.
2	**(a)** laughing heartily	He laughed, then became serious, moved by the man's faith.
3	**(c)** since	'Since' is used with a point in time.
4	**(c)** hopeful but dependent on the weather	His whole hope rested on rain for the ripe corn.
5	**(d)** protect Lencho's faith	He did not want to destroy so great a faith.
6	**(a)** hopelessness	Despair = loss of all hope.
7	**(b)** new coins	He saw the drops as coins - the wealth he expected.
8	**(d)** his employees and friends, and gave part of his salary	He gave from his own pay; others contributed.
9	**(b)** trusting	Sceptical = doubting; trusting is the opposite.
10	**(b)** hailstones	A strong wind brought hail, which flattened the field.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The corn was ripe (1) and he wanted rain to come, as only that was needed for the crop to be complete (1).	1+1
12	He believed God knew everything (1) and could therefore help without being told by anyone else (1).	1+1
13	Seventy pesos (1), which was only a part of what he had asked for (1).	1+1
14	He saw the large drops as new coins (1), a symbol of the money the harvest would bring him (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Lencho lived on a hill in a valley (1). The ripe corn field was dotted with flowers promising a good harvest (1). He expected a shower of rain to make it perfect (1).	1+1+1
16	He showed no surprise at the envelope (1) but became angry when he counted the notes (1). This shows his total trust in God and mistrust in people (1).	1+1+1
17	Lencho said that he would write to God (1). 'Will' changes to 'would' in reported speech (1). Example: He said, 'I am sad' becomes He said that he was sad (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Joy at the rain turned to fear as ice began to fall (1). The crop was ruined and the field looked as if covered in salt (1). He was left with sadness and worry for his family (1).	1+1+1
18	He thought God could not have made a mistake in the amount (1). So he concluded that the clerks had kept some money (1). He called them dishonest people (1).	1+1+1
	OR: destroyed (1), had reached (1). Past perfect shows the earlier action finished before another past action (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Hardworking farmer (1) who lives with his family in a valley. Deeply religious, sure that God will help (1). Innocent and simple, believes God can read a letter (1). Stubborn and suspicious of people, blaming the clerks (1). Overall: a man of faith and limited understanding (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening: faith gives strength (1). Lencho's crop is destroyed yet he hopes (1). He writes a letter and waits for help (1). Help comes through human kindness (1). Conclusion with personal view (1).	2+2+1
20	Fat, friendly head of the village post office (1). Sensitive: he laughs at first, then is moved (1). Generous: contributes money from his salary (1). Clever: writes a reply as God to preserve faith (1). A model of kindness who still cannot escape being called a crook (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Nature gives the farmer his hope, as ripe corn needs rain (1). The same nature destroys through hail (1). The farmer is helpless against it (1). Weather decides life in agriculture (1). Nature thus causes the whole plot (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lencho *asked for 100 pesos and the postmaster sent 100*; the postmaster could collect only about 70 pesos, which is why Lencho later complains.
- Saying Lencho lost faith in God; his faith in God stays unshaken. He doubts only the **post-office employees**, calling them a 'bunch of crooks'.
- Mixing up the weather images: the raindrops were like *new coins* (a simile), and the hail did more damage than a plague of locusts; do not call both 'hail like coins'.
- Ignoring the **irony** in the ending: the man who trusts God completely is the one who suspects honest people; the postmaster's kindness is exactly what Lencho fails to see.
- Writing that the postmaster ignored the letter; he first laughed, then was moved, and wrote a reply signed **'God'** to keep Lencho's faith alive.
- Spelling slips: *Lencho, postmaster, hailstorm, plague of locusts*; and using 'who' for things (the letter *which*, not who).

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** seventy pesos	Not enough, because the funds were limited.
2	**(a)** friendly	Amiable = pleasant and friendly.
3	**(b)** salt	The white hail lay on the field like salt.
4	**(d)** God	The postmaster signed it 'God' to keep up the illusion.
5	**(a)** Lencho said that he needed rain.	Present becomes past; 'I' becomes 'he'.
6	**(b)** the hail had destroyed the whole crop	Not a single ear of corn was left.
7	**(c)** anger because it was less than he asked	He thought the post office staff had kept the rest.
8	**(c)** a rural farming valley	A farmer's house in a valley.
9	**(d)** his belief that God would help	He had firm faith in God.
10	**(c)** not through the mail	He called the post office employees a bunch of crooks.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He asked for one hundred pesos (1) so that he could sow the field again and survive till the next harvest (1).	1+1
12	He believed they had taken the missing money (1) and called them crooks (1).	1+1
13	It was covered with white hail (1) and not a single ear of corn was left (1).	1+1
14	He first laughed (1) and then grew serious, moved by the faith of the writer (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He wrote to God for help, sure that God could read his need (1). He did not doubt that his request would be answered (1). He even asked for the exact sum of one hundred pesos (1).	1+1+1
16	The first was rain, which looked like coins and brought hope (1). The second was hail, which destroyed the crop (1). The change shows how quickly fortune can turn for a farmer (1).	1+1+1
17	Compassion is deep sympathy for another's suffering (1). The postmaster felt sorry for Lencho (1) and gave money and time to help him (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He was touched by Lencho's firm faith (1). He did not want that belief to be shaken (1). So he gathered money and wrote a reply signed 'God' (1).	1+1+1
18	Lencho is helped by people but blames them (1). He thinks God made no error yet is sure the clerks stole (1). This contradiction creates gentle irony at the end (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He valued faith as precious (1). He could have ignored the letter but chose to help (1). This shows his kindness and wisdom (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Rain and then hail wreck the corn field (1). Lencho consoles his family with his faith (1). He writes and posts the letter to God (1). The postmaster reads, laughs and decides to help; collects seventy pesos (1). He replies signing 'God' (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Lencho trusts God but not men (1). Men actually helped him (1). He expects more, calling them crooks (1). The postmaster's kindness is unrewarded (1). Reader smiles while sympathising with both (1).	2+2+1
20	Format: sender's address, date, salutation (1). Introduce the story and Lencho (1). Describe hail and the letter (1). Mention the postmaster's help and Lencho's reaction (1). Closing line with your reflection and signature (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date and heading (1). Describe joy at the rain (1). Describe the hail and ruin of the crop (1). Express faith and decision to write to God (1). Ending with hope and sadness for his family (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lencho *asked for 100 pesos and the postmaster sent 100*; the postmaster could collect only about 70 pesos, which is why Lencho later complains.
- Saying Lencho lost faith in God; his faith in God stays unshaken. He doubts only the **post-office employees**, calling them a 'bunch of crooks'.
- Mixing up the weather images: the raindrops were like *new coins* (a simile), and the hail did more damage than a plague of locusts; do not call both 'hail like coins'.
- Ignoring the **irony** in the ending: the man who trusts God completely is the one who suspects honest people; the postmaster's kindness is exactly what Lencho fails to see.
- Writing that the postmaster ignored the letter; he first laughed, then was moved, and wrote a reply signed **'God'** to keep Lencho's faith alive.
- Spelling slips: *Lencho, postmaster, hailstorm, plague of locusts*; and using 'who' for things (the letter *which*, not who).

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** compassionate	He helped even at personal cost.
2	**(d)** believed God knew everything and could help	His faith in God's all-knowing nature drove him.
3	**(b)** dishonest people	Lencho accused the clerks of dishonesty.
4	**(a)** ironic	Lencho's ingratitude towards his helpers is ironic.
5	**(a)** one hundred pesos	He needed 100 pesos to sow the field again and live till harvest.
6	**(d)** faith in God and mistrust of people	Faith in God but suspicion of humans.
7	**(d)** metaphor	The drops are directly called coins, with no 'like' or 'as'.
8	**(b)** God	The address he wrote was simply 'To God'.
9	**(c)** The crop was destroyed by the hail.	'was destroyed' with 'by the hail' - passive.
10	**(d)** Gregorio Lopez y Fuentes	A Mexican writer.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He is the head of the local post office (1) and is kind and sensitive (1).	1+1
12	He told them that all was not lost (1) because they could still rely on God's help (1).	1+1
13	He decided to reply (1) and collect money to help Lencho keep his faith (1).	1+1
14	He thanked God for the money (1) and asked for the rest to be sent directly, not by post (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He gave a part of his own salary (1). His friends were asked to help (1). Even then he could gather only seventy pesos (1).	1+1+1
16	Lencho keeps looking at the sky for rain (1). The sky seems to bring both hope and despair (1). It sets up the theme of dependence on nature (1).	1+1+1
17	A lonely house on a hill in a valley (1). Fields of ripe corn with flowers (1). A nearby town with a post office, where the postmaster works (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He wanted the letter to look as if God had written it (1). He had to choose appropriate words and sign as God (1). He also knew he could not send the full amount (1).	1+1+1
18	They depend wholly on weather (1). One storm can destroy a year's labour (1). They need hope and faith to continue (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Hope of rain versus disaster of hail (1). Faith in God versus distrust of men (1). Laughter of the postmaster versus his later seriousness (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Admirable: unshaken faith helped him bear the loss (1). Foolish: he expected money to come without any human effort (1). He blamed honest helpers (1). Balanced view: faith is good but must be joined with gratitude and sense (2).	2+2+1
	OR: Correct dialogue format with names (1). Postmaster explains the letter and the need (1). Staff react with surprise or laughter, then agree (1). Amount fixed at what they can give (1). Closing: decide to sign the letter as God (1).	2+2+1
20	Faith can give strength in hardship (1). Kindness towards others, like the postmaster's, is a noble act (1). Human nature is shown to be both trusting and suspicious (1). Blind faith may lead to wrong conclusions (1). The story balances humour and sympathy (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Salutation and address of Lencho (1). Say that his request has been heard (1). Enclose a part of the money, mention the small amount (1). Advise him to work hard and keep faith (1). Sign off as God (1).	2+2+1

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